

Consequently, while the fundamental structure of Sri Lanka's religious composition remained stable during the 12-year period between the last two censuses, the proportional growth of the Muslim community and the slight percentage decreases in the Buddhist and Catholic communities are identified as the primary population trends.

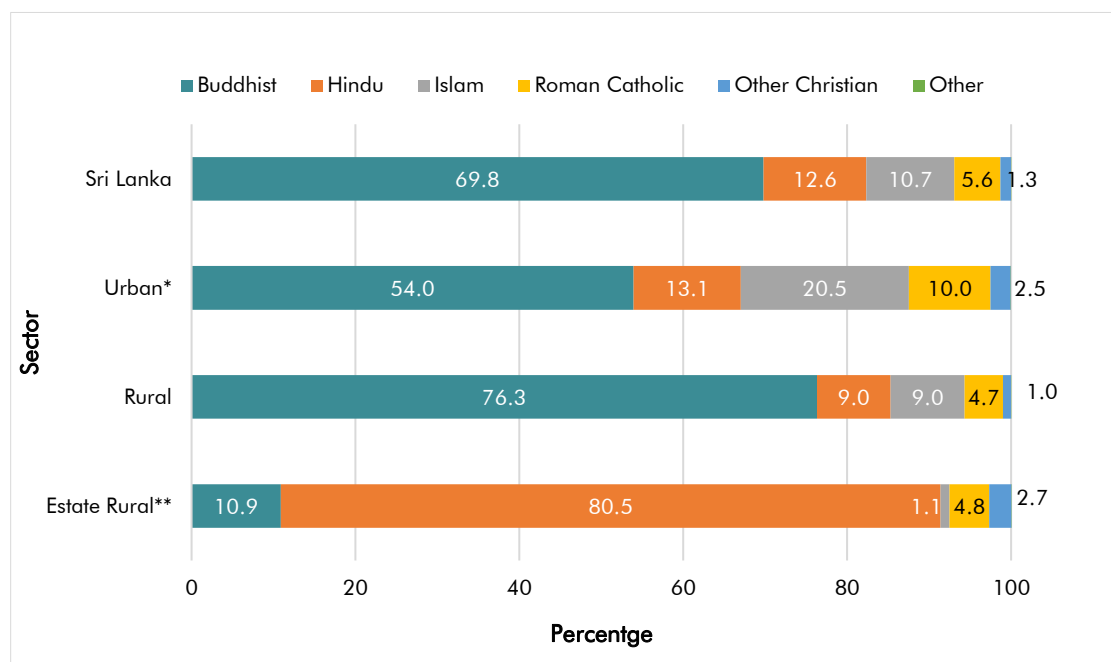
Table 6.1.13 : Population and Percentage Distribution by Sector and Religion, 2024

Sector	Total	Religion					
		Buddhist	Hindu	Islam	Roman Catholic	Other Christian	Other
Sri Lanka	21,781,800	15,199,093	2,734,839	2,337,379	1,224,348	282,185	3,956
	100.0	69.8	12.6	10.7	5.6	1.3	0.0
Urban*	3,819,203	2,060,541	498,717	783,638	380,543	94,038	1,726
	100.0	54.0	13.0	20.5	10.0	2.5	0.0
Rural	17,096,918	13,044,342	1,539,173	1,544,664	801,977	164,634	2,128
	100.0	76.3	9.0	9.0	4.7	1.0	0.0
Estate Rural**	865,679	94,210	696,949	9,077	41,828	23,513	102
	100.0	10.9	80.5	1.1	4.8	2.7	0.0

*Although the Census 2024 collected data separately for "Urban" and "Estate Urban" sectors, these two categories have been combined and presented as "Urban" to facilitate easier comparison with 2012 Census data

**The category identified as "Estate" in the Census 2012 is presented as "Estate Rural" in the Census 2024.

As illustrated in Table 6.1.13 and Figure 6.1.16, the distribution of the population by religion varies across the urban, rural, and estate rural sectors. The urban sector displays a diverse religious composition, while the rural sector is characterized by a Buddhist majority. In contrast, the estate rural sector records a predominant Hindu majority.



*Although the Census 2024 collected data separately for "Urban" and "Estate Urban" sectors, these two categories have been combined and presented as "Urban" to facilitate easier comparison with 2012 Census data

**The category identified as "Estate" in the Census 2012 is presented as "Estate Rural" in the Census 2024.

Figure 6.1.16 : Percentage Distribution of the Population by Sector and Religion, 2024